UCLA Extension

396816: Investments in Personal Financial Planning MGMT-X 430.32

Spring 2024 Section 1 4 Credits 04/01/2024 to 06/16/2024 Modified 01/25/2024

Meeting Times

This course takes place fully online and will not include required scheduled live meetings. Please note the following:

- Each course week starts on Wednesday 12:00 AM and ends on Tuesday 11:59 PM Pacific Time (US) (note that the last week of the course is extended through Sunday).
- *Optional* live meetings are offered as an opportunity for you to expand your knowledge in this field and connect with your instructor and classmates. Meetings will occur via Zoom on Tuesdays at 5pm Pacific Time (US). The meetings will be recorded.

Description

An examination of the role of various investment vehicles in meeting financial goals, securities markets, sources of information about the various instruments traded and the procedure of trades. This course introduces various market theories, including modern portfolio theory and the extension to this theory by Markowitz and Sharpe. Other topics include the analysis of business cycles; market analysis; analysis of individual companies; the market in debt instruments; and alternative instruments, including options, warrants, convertibles, commodity futures, mutual funds and tangibles.

Objectives

The investment world is complex and ever changing. During this course, you will:

- Prepare for successful completion of the PFP Practicum and the investment part of the CFP examination
- Evaluate topics which the financial planner and sophisticated investor should be aware of to competently construct, execute, and monitor investment plans.
- Explore advanced concepts, techniques, and theories in investment analysis and portfolio management. Core concepts include:
  - Introduction to financial securities
  - Securities markets and information sources
  - Global markets and foreign securities

- Risk and return metrics
- Efficient capital markets theory/modern portfolio concepts
- Securities valuation concepts
- Multiple approaches to security selection
- Technical analysis
- Behavioral finance
- Fixed income securities
- Derivatives overview including options and futures
- Mutual Funds and investment companies
- Portfolio management

Outcomes

By the end of this course, you should be able to:

- Explain common, preferred stock and fixed income investments
- Discuss securities markets and identify information sources
- Evaluate the benefits of global investing
- Describe the measurements of and relationship between and risk and return
- Summarize efficient capital markets theory and modern portfolio concepts
- Analyze and apply securities valuation concepts
- Become conversant with multiple approaches to security selection and apply them in exam problems and case studies
- Compare and contrast technical analysis to behavioral finance
- Discuss the characteristics and nuances of fixed income securities
- Explain the unique nature of derivatives including options and futures
- Analyze and apply mutual Funds, ETFs, closed-end funds, REITs and alternative investments to a case study and exam problems
- Use portfolio management concepts to create and/or adjust investment portfolios

Materials

Required Reading Materials

Investments: An Introduction, 13th Edition
Author: Mayo, Herbert B.
Publisher: Cengage Learning

Recommended Reading Materials

Note: The following resources are recommended, but are not required for this course.

- **Wall Street Journal**
  Dow Jones & Company, Daily

- Barron's
  Dow Jones & Company, Weekly

- Malkiel, Burton, ***A Random Walk Down Wall Street***, W.W.Norton 1996

- Graham, Benjamin (Revised edition), ***The Intelligent Investor***, HarperBusiness Essentials, 1973-2003.

- Greenwald, Bruce C. L., Judd Kahn, Paul D. Sonkin, Michael van Biema, ***Value Investing: From Graham To Buffett And Beyond***, Wiley Finance, 2001.

- Greenblatt, Joel, ***The Little Book That Still Beats The Market***, John Wiley & Sons, Inc, 2010.
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- CFP Board, ***The Psychology of Financial Planning***, Certified Financial Planner Board of Standards, Inc.

✔ Evaluation

Criteria

Your final grade (of possible 100 points) will be composed of participation, two exams and a final assignment—the Bedo Case Study.

Graded Activities	Points	Notes
Discussion Participation	20 points	20 total points will be given for weekly participation in the Canvas discussion forums. Requirements: • At least one substantial initial post for each discussion • At least one meaningful response to another classmate's post Responses should be done on at least 2 days every week with at least one of those responses occurring within the first 4 days of each week. Relevant responses add to the discussions via questions, real world examples, alternative ideas and concepts. I will be checking the discussions every day and will be participating at least 2-3 days each week, as well.
Exams	50 points	2 exams (25 points each). The first must be completed during Week Five, and the second during the Week Eight.
Bedo Case Study	30 points	A Bedo Case Study worth 30 points will become available during Week Five and is due by the last day of the class.
TOTAL	100 points	

Breakdown

Grade	Range
A	100% - 90%
B	< 90% to 80%
C	< 80% to 73%

Grade	Range
F	< 73% to 0%

Course Policies

Course Format: Online

This course is designed to be completed entirely online. All course activities and assignments will be managed through Canvas – you will use your unique username and password to log into the course, interact with your instructor and fellow students, and submit any required assignments.

Since attendance is asynchronous (not in real time), you may login at any time of the day. However, you are expected to participate in the virtual classroom on a weekly basis and complete all readings, discussion requirements and assignments/exams as required.

Assignments, Late Work, & Grading

- Assignment details and instructions are provided within the assignments in the Modules area of Canvas.
- I will be checking the Canvas discussion boards every day and will be participating at least 2-3 days a week, as well.
- Late Work and Extension Policies
  - Discussion threads will automatically close at the end of each week--Tuesday nights at 11:59pm (PT). The ability to post after then will not be available.
  - The assignments will be penalized 1 point per day late. All work must be submitted by the end of the course.
  - There are no make-up assignments or extra credit available.
- Please keep a copy of all assignments and work submitted. Print the syllabus for your reference. It is your responsibility to be aware of all assignments, due dates, and guidelines.
- I will be providing your feedback to you every week, approximately 7 days after the end of each week. You will be able to view my feedback and your grades within the "Grades" area of Canvas.
- All grades are final.
- Students must follow all posted deadlines and must complete all work in Canvas by the end of the course.

Planning Your Study Time

To plan your study time, it is estimated that you will spend approximately 3 hours per week "in class" engaging with the material, classmates, and the instructor and up to 9 additional hours per week outside of class studying for exams, reading, and completing assignments. Depending on the extent of your academic preparation and recent college-level coursework in this topic area, the amount of study time needed may vary considerably.

Instructor Expectations

Class, to do well in this course requires reading the materials, participating in the discussions early and often during the week and completing your assignments on a timely basis. Plus, be sure to always be professional in your discussion posts; adding real world illustrations is very helpful to all.

Institutional Policies

Student Conduct

Students are subject to disciplinary action for several types of misconduct or attempted misconduct, including but not limited to academic dishonesty, such as cheating, multiple submission, plagiarism, or knowingly furnishing false information to the University; or behavioral misconduct, such as theft or misuse of the intellectual property of others, harassment, or disruption of the learning environment.

All published and unpublished material, whether in manuscript, printed or electronic form, is covered under this definition and includes the use of material generated wholly or in part through the use of artificial intelligence (except when the use of AI has received prior authorization for assessment as a reasonable accommodation for a student's disability, or when the use of AI is a specified part of the coursework, e.g. data science or user experience). Students are encouraged to familiarize themselves with the Student Rights & Responsibilities Policy (https://www.uclaextension.edu/student-services/rights-and-responsibilities) and to report concerns.

Services for Students with Disabilities

In accordance with the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990, UCLA Extension provides appropriate accommodations and support services to qualified applicants and students with disabilities. These include, but are not limited to, auxiliary aids/services such as sign language interpreters, assistive listening devices for hearing-impaired individuals, extended time for and proctoring of exams, and registration assistance. Accommodations and types of support services vary and are specifically designed to meet the disability-related needs of each student based on current, verifiable medical documentation. Arrangements for auxiliary aids/services are available only through UCLA Extension's Service for Students with Disabilities Office at (310) 825-7851 or by email at ODS@uclaextension.edu. For complete information, please visit Accessibility and Disability Services (https://www.uclaextension.edu/enrollment-and-support/accessibility-and-disability-services).

Incompletes

The interim grade Incomplete (I) may be approved for a student who has completed the majority of the course requirements, with passing quality (grade C or higher), but is unable to complete a small portion of the coursework by the course end date for good cause. For courses in which an Incomplete may be allowed, approval by the instructor of record and the academic program director is required. The Incomplete grade is not an option for courses that do not bear credit, such as 700, 800, or 900-level courses.

- It is the student's responsibility to petition for an Incomplete by emailing the appropriate academic program department (https://www.uclaextension.edu/contact-ucla-extension) at least one week before the end of the course. The Program Department will initiate the petition process once the email is received.
- The student, the instructor, the CE/Program Director, and the program staff must complete the petition prior to the final course meeting or before the quarter end date (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar). This process can take up to one week to complete.
- The instructor will approve or deny the request. The instructor will provide details on what the student needs to accomplish in order to complete the course, as well as a due date for submitting completed work. The due date cannot exceed the end of the ensuing quarter (https://www.uclaextension.edu/calendar) when a final grade must be reported or the Incomplete lapses to the grade "F," "NP," or "U." Visit UCLA Extension Grading Scale (https://www.uclaextension.edu/transcripts-credits-grades/grading-scale) for more information.

An Incomplete allows the student to complete only work that is outstanding and does not allow prior completed work to be retaken or resubmitted.

All Grades are Final

No change of grade may be made by anyone other than the instructor, and then, only to correct clerical errors. No term grade except Incomplete may be revised by re-examination. The correction of a clerical error may be authorized only by the instructor of record communicating directly with personnel of Student and Alumni Services.

Sexual Harassment

The University of California is committed to creating and maintaining a community where all individuals who participate in University programs and activities can work and learn together in an atmosphere free of harassment, exploitation, or intimidation. Every member of the community should be aware that the University prohibits sexual harassment and sexual violence, and that such behavior violates both law and University policy. The University will respond promptly and effectively to reports of sexual harassment and sexual violence, and will take appropriate action to prevent, to correct, and when necessary, to discipline behavior that violates our policy.

All Extension students and instructors who believe they have been sexually harassed are encouraged to contact the Department of Student and Alumni Services for complaint resolution: UCLA Extension, 1145 Gayley Ave., Los Angeles, CA 90024; Voice/TTY: (310) 825-7031. For more information, please view the University's full Policy on Sexual Harassment and Sexual Violence (https://policy.ucop.edu/doc/4000385/SVSH).

Additional Items

Protecting Privacy and Data During Live Instruction

Live meeting sessions for this class, when applicable, are being conducted over Zoom. As the host, the instructor may be recording live sessions. Only the host has the ability to record meetings, no recording by other means is permitted. Recorded sessions will be posted in the Videos area of this class unless otherwise notified. Due to privacy, recordings are not available for download and are only accessible via Canvas for the duration of the class. If you have privacy concerns and do not wish to appear in the recording, do not turn on your video and/or audio. If you also prefer to use a pseudonym instead of your name, please let the instructor know what name you will be using so that the instructor knows who you are during the session. To rename yourself during a Zoom meeting, click on Participants, click on your name, click on More, click on Rename. If you would like to ask a question, you may do so privately through the Zoom chat by addressing your chat question to the instructor only (and not to ""everyone""). Additionally, chat may be used and moderated for live questions, and saving of chats is enabled. If you have questions or concerns about this, please contact the instructor via Canvas Inbox.

Pursuant to the terms of the agreement between Zoom and UCLA Extension, the data is used solely for this purpose and Zoom is prohibited from re-disclosing this information. UCLA Extension also does not use the data for any other purpose. Recordings will be deleted when no longer necessary. However, recordings may become part of an administrative disciplinary record if misconduct occurs during a video conference.

Course and Instructor Evaluation

UCLA Extension values your feedback on course and instructor evaluations. We ask all students to take a few minutes to complete an end-of-course evaluation survey. Updates to the course and instruction are influenced by your feedback. Understanding your student experience is essential to ensure continuing excellence in the online classroom and is appreciated by your instructor and the UCLA Extension academic leadership.

Your participation in a survey is voluntary, and your responses are confidential. After instructors submit grades, they will be given an evaluation report, but this report will not contain your name.

About Your Online Course Materials

Please note the following about online course components at UCLA Extension:

- Students must have basic computer skills, including the use of word processing software, email, and the ability to use internet browsers, such as Safari, Firefox, or Chrome.
- Students are responsible for meeting the technical requirements of Canvas and familiarizing themselves with the Canvas Learning Management System.
  - What are the browser and computer requirements for Canvas? (https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Basics-Guide/What-are-the-browser-and-computer-requirements-for-Instructure/ta-p/66)
- Students are responsible for keeping a copy of all assignments and work submitted, and to be aware of all assignments, due dates, and course guidelines.
- Students have access to courses via Canvas for an additional 30 calendar days after the course end date listed in the syllabus (the first 14 days are full access; the rest are read-only).

- Students are encouraged to download/print content throughout the duration of the course and before the additional 30-day access ends. No further access is possible after the course becomes unavailable.

  To download all your assignment submissions in Canvas, please refer to the online support guide. (https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10606) for more information or contact Canvas Support via the help menu within Canvas.

UCLA Extension Canvas and Learning Support

For immediate 24/7 Canvas technical support, including holidays, click on **Help** (located on the menu to the left) where you can call or chat live with a Canvas Support representative.

UCLA Extension Academic Technology and Learning Innovation
The UCLA Extension Learning Support staff assists both students and instructors with Canvas-related technical support, as well as general and administrative questions.

Learning Support staff is available Monday through Friday, from 8 AM to 9 PM (Pacific Time), except holidays:

- Email: atli@uclaextension.edu (mailto:atli@uclaextension.edu)

Campus Safety Escorts

For students taking classes held on the UCLA campus and in and around Westwood Village, the UCLA Police Department provides a free walking escort service every day of the year from dusk until 1 a.m. Community Service Officers (CSOs) are available to walk students, faculty, staff members and visitors to and from anywhere on campus, in Westwood Village, and in the village apartments. CSOs are uniformed students who have received special training and are employed by the UCLA Police Department. To obtain an escort, please call (310) 794-9255 and allow 15 to 20 minutes for your escort to arrive. For complete information, see UCLA Evening Escorts (https://police.ucla.edu/cso/evening-escorts).

Schedule

When	Module Title	Notes

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Week One (4/3/24 to 4/9/24)	Introduction to Financial Assets and Security Markets	Lesson Topics: • Introduction to investments • Diversification • Securities markets • Regulations • Initial Public Offerings Activities: • Read Chapters 1 & 2 • Complete Discussion: Introduce Yourself - Response due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Introduction to Investments - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Securities Markets - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)
Week Two (4/10/23 to 4/16/24)	Time Value of Money, Financial Planning, Taxation and Market Efficiency	Lesson Topics: • Time value of money • Present value • Future value • Financial planning process • Market efficiency • Taxation Activities: • Read Chapters 3 & 4 • Complete Discussion: Time Value of Money - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Financial Planning, Efficiency and Taxation - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)

When	Module Title	Notes
Week Three (4/17/24 to 4/23/24)	Risk, Portfolio Theory, and Investment Return	Lesson Topics: • Risk • Modern Portfolio Theory • Return metrics Activities: • Read Chapters 5 & 10 • Complete Discussion: Risk and Portfolio Theory - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Return Metrics - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)
Week Four (4/24/24 to 4/30/24)	Investment Companies	Lesson Topics: • Mutual funds • Exchange-traded funds • Closed-end funds • REITs Activities: • Read Chapters 6 & 7 • Complete Discussion: Mutual Funds - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)

When	Module Title	Notes
Week Five (5/1/24 to 5/7/24)	Common Stock Valuation	Lesson Topics: • Common stock • Preferred stock • Financial statement analysis • Common stock valuation Activities: • **Read Chapters 8 & 9** • **Complete Discussion: Stock** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Discussion: Common Stock Valuation** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Exam 1** - Due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Begin working on the Bedo Case Study assignment** - Case Study to be completed by Sunday, 9/4, 11:59 PM (PT)
Week Six (5/8/24 to 5/14/24)	Macroeconomic Environment, Behavioral Finance and Technical Analysis of Common Stocks	Lesson Topics: • Macroeconomics • Behavioral finance • Technical analysis Activities: • **Read Chapters 11 & 12** • **Complete Discussion: Macroeconomics** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Discussion: Behavioral Finance and Technical Analysis** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Mid-Course Survey** (Optional) - Due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)

When	Module Title	Notes
Week Seven (5/15/24 to 5/21/24)	Fixed Income Fundamentals and Valuation	Lesson Topics: • Bonds • Valuation of bonds • Valuation of preferred stock • Yields • Duration Activities: • Read Chapters 13 & 14 • Complete Discussion: Bonds - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Fixed-Income Valuation - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)
Week Eight (5/22/24 to 5/28/24)	Government Bonds and Convertible Securities	Lesson Topics: • Treasury securities • Municipal bonds • Foreign government debt securities • Convertible bonds • Convertible preferred stock Activities: • Read Chapters 15 & 16 • Complete Discussion: Government Securities - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Discussion: Convertible Securities - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • Complete Exam 2 - Due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)

When	Module Title	Notes
Week Nine (5/29/24 to 6/4/24)	Options	Lesson Topics: • Options • Option valuation • Option strategies Activities: • **Read Chapters 17 & 18** • **Complete Discussion: Options** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Discussion: Option Valuation and Strategies** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Tuesday, 11:59 PM (PT)
Week Ten (6/5/24 to 6/16/24)	Commodities and Portfolio Planning and Performance Evaluation, Case Study	Lesson Topics: • Portfolio Construction and Management • Security Selection • Commodity and financial futures Activities: • **Read Chapters 19 & 20** • **Complete Discussion: Course Reflection** - Initial response due Saturday, 11:59 PM (PT); Replies to peers due Sunday, 6/16, 11:59 PM (PT) • **Complete Bedo Case Study Assignment** - Due Sunday, 6/16, 11:59 PM (PT)